PRAXIS

Responsible Lobbying Policy

How we use our voice in public policy, what we will not do with it, and what we are doing on our own behalf right now, which is very little.

Issued by	Praxis Brands Ltd, trading as Stennah & Hope, company no. 17222158
Applies to	Praxis Brands Ltd, its directors, its workers, and anyone acting on our behalf, including trade bodies and coalitions we belong to
Accountable	The Board of Directors, which approves this Policy and does not delegate accountability for it
Read with	Human Rights Commitment; JEDI Commitment; Responsible Procurement Policy; Stakeholder Grievance Procedure v2.2; Memberships & Positions Log
Version / date	Dated on the day the Board adopts it.
Review	Every 12 months from adoption

1. Purpose and scope

This Policy sets out how we engage, directly or through others, with public officials, policymakers and the making of public policy. It covers political donations, trade and industry association membership, the public positions we take, and political activity by the people who work here.

It applies to the whole of Praxis Brands Ltd, in the United Kingdom, and to anyone speaking on our behalf.

2. What we mean by lobbying

We use B Lab's definition. Lobbying and advocacy mean communicating, directly or indirectly, with public officials, policymakers or their representatives with the aim of influencing public decision-making.

The word that matters here is **indirectly**. A trade body that puts our industry's case to government is lobbying on our behalf, whether or not we asked it to. This Policy covers that as much as anything we say ourselves.

3. Our position

We are a micro manufacturer. We do not employ or retain lobbyists, we have no government affairs function, and we have not to date made representations to government in our own name.

We do not rule out doing so. Our public purpose concerns who gets access to premium manufacture, and there may be policy questions on which we should speak. Where we do, this Policy governs how.

4. How we will lobby, where we do

For positive impact. We will engage only where we believe the outcome would be good for people or the environment, not merely good for us.

On evidence. Our positions will rest on reliable data, and we will say what that evidence is. Where we are arguing from our own experience rather than from data, we will say that instead of dressing it up.

Consistently with our commitments. Our positions must be consistent with our public purpose, this document set, and the B Lab Standards. We will not argue in public for one thing and in private for another.

Openly. Any position we take will be recorded in our Memberships & Positions Log and published in our annual impact report.

5. Political donations and party politics

We make no donations to political parties, candidates, campaign groups or elected representatives, in money or in kind, and we do not intend to. Any change to that would require a Board decision, recorded and published.

The people who work here are free to take part in politics in their own time, in their own name. We do not fund it, direct it, or ask about it, and nobody's standing here depends on their politics.

6. Trade and industry associations

Membership of a trade body means someone is speaking for our industry, and so for us. We accept responsibility for that.

We record every membership in our Memberships & Positions Log, with what that body advocates for.

We review each one annually against this Policy and our other commitments.

Where a body takes a position, we consider inconsistent with our commitments, we will say so to them, record that we did, and decide whether to remain a member. If we stay, we will record why.

We hold no trade body memberships at present. British Candlemakers Federation membership did not transfer from our predecessor company and is being re-established, targeted for Q1 2027. Made in Britain membership is being re-established by Q4 2026. Until each is in place the Log shows no memberships, and this Policy says so rather than implying an affiliation we do not hold.

7. What we will not do

Pay for access to a public official or offer anything of value in exchange for influence.

Argue for a position we know to be unsupported by evidence.

Lobby, directly or through a trade body, against environmental or labour protections.

Conceal who is speaking for us or speak through a front organisation.

8. How this Policy is put into practice

At our size, embedding a policy is not a training programme. It is one approval step and one record, applied every time, by the two people who could possibly speak for the company.

Who may speak for the company

Only the Board and the Managing Director may take a public policy position in the Company's name, or commit the Company to a trade body, coalition or campaign. No worker, contractor, agency or adviser is authorised to do so, and nobody acquires that authority by seniority, convenience or custom.

The approval step

Before the Company does any of the following, the Managing Director must approve it in writing and it must be entered in the Memberships & Positions Log:

1. joining, renewing or leaving a trade body, industry association or coalition;
2. responding to a government or regulator consultation;
3. writing to, meeting or making representations to a public official, policymaker, councillor or MP in the Company's name;
4. signing an open letter, pledge or campaign statement;
5. publishing a public position on a matter of policy or regulation.

Where the matter concerns the Managing Director personally, or where the Managing Director is conflicted, approval falls to the other Director. Approval is recorded with the date, the position taken, who approved it and **the evidence relied on**, because section 4 requires a position to rest on evidence and an approval that does not name the evidence cannot show that it did.

How people come to know this Policy

Who	How they receive it	When
Directors	Adopted at Board; a copy held with the governance document set	On adoption and at each annual review
Workers, including agency workers	Issued at induction with the Employee Handbook, and reissued whenever it is revised	At induction; on revision
Trade bodies and coalitions	Sent to the body on joining, with a note that we review its public positions annually against it	Before we join
Advisers, agencies and anyone acting for us	Sent before they act for us, with written confirmation that they will not make representations in our name	Before engagement
The public	Published with our other commitments	On publication

Where it is written down

The Memberships & Positions Log one row for each membership and each position taken, holding the date, the body or forum, what was said, the evidence relied on, who approved it, and the outcome. The Log is the evidence that this Policy operates; this document is only the rule.

The Employee Handbook - the rule that no worker speaks for the Company on public policy, and the route for raising a concern if they believe we have.

The Board's standing agenda - purpose and impact is taken before other business at every Board meeting, and lobbying falls within it.

The annual impact report - every position taken in the year, every membership held, and any case where this Policy was not followed.

9. Identifying, managing and monitoring the risk of non-compliance

These are the ways this Policy could be breached, how we would find out, and what happens then. The list is reviewed annually and added to when something we did not foresee occurs.

Risk	How we would detect it	What we do about it
A trade body lobbies in our name on a position inconsistent with our commitments. **Our most likely breach, because it does not require anyone here to do anything.**	Annual review of each membership against this Policy; reading the body's published positions and consultation responses; any concern raised with us	Write to the body setting out the inconsistency; record that we did; decide whether to remain a member and record the reason either way; disclose in the annual impact report
Someone speaks for the Company on policy without authority.	The approval step and the Log: any position not in the Log was not approved. Also through concerns raised by anyone who saw it	Correct the record publicly where the statement was public; record what happened; remind the person of the rule in writing
A position is taken on evidence that is weak, absent or misrepresented.	The approval step requires the evidence to be named before approval; the annual review tests whether each logged position names it	Withdraw or restate the position; record the correction; report it in the annual impact report
Something of value is offered to, or requested by, a public official — a bribery risk under the Bribery Act 2010.	Review of expenses and hospitality by the Director who did not incur them; any concern raised	Stop the payment; investigate; report to the appropriate authority where required; record the decision and its reasons in the minutes
A political donation is made without being recognised as one — a sponsorship, a table at an event, a raffle prize.	Review of expenses against section 5 at each quarterly Board review	Recover or cease the payment where possible; record it; a deliberate change of position requires a Board decision, recorded and published
A Director's own political activity is mistaken for the Company's, or shapes a Company position.	Declaration of interests at the start of every Board meeting, and in the approval step	The conflicted Director takes no part in the approval; the other Director approves; the conflict and its handling are minuted
The Log falls out of date, so there is nothing to review.	Quarterly check by the Managing Director that the Log matches what actually happened	Bring the Log up to date, record the gap and its length rather than closing it silently

Monitoring

Quarterly. The Managing Director reviews the Memberships & Positions Log against what happened in the quarter, and reports to the Board.

Annually. The Board reviews every membership, every logged position and this Policy, as set out in section 10.

On any concern raised. A concern about our lobbying or business conduct is handled under the Stakeholder Grievance Procedure and reported to the Board, whatever the time of year.

On any change. A new membership, a first representation to government, or a request from a trade body to sign something triggers the approval step and, with it, a fresh look at the risks above.

10. How we evaluate compliance with this Policy

Once a year the Board tests whether this Policy was actually followed, rather than confirming that it exists. The test is the same each year so that one year can be compared with another.

What the annual review tests

Question	Evidence examined	Pass condition
Was every membership reviewed against this Policy?	Memberships & Positions Log; the body's published positions	Every membership has a dated review entry
Was every position taken approved before it was taken, and logged?	The Log, read against the Company's public statements, correspondence and consultation responses for the year	No position exists that is not in the Log, and none was logged after the event without that being recorded
Did every logged position name the evidence relied on?	The Log	Every entry names its evidence, or records that the position rested on our own experience
Were any political donations made?	Expenses, bank records, sponsorship and event spend	None, or a Board decision recorded and published
Did anyone speak for the Company without authority?	Concerns raised; public statements; the Log	No instance, or an instance recorded with what was done about it
Is the register of interests current?	Board minutes	Declarations made at every meeting
Was any concern raised about our lobbying or business conduct?	Grievance Register	Every concern recorded, answered within the published deadline, and its outcome logged

Who performs it, and how the conclusion is recorded

The review is performed by **the Board**. Where a position was approved by one Director, **the other Director leads the review of it**, so that approving and evaluating are not done by the same person.

The Board records one of three conclusions for the year, in the minutes: **compliant**; **not compliant**, with what happened and what was done about it; or **not testable**, where no lobbying activity occurred.

A year with no activity is still reviewed, and the conclusion records that there was nothing to test. An absence of activity is not evidence of compliance, and we do not report it as though it were.

The conclusion, including any failure, is published in the annual impact report. A failure is reported whether anyone outside the Company noticed it.

Where the Policy was not followed, the Board sets a corrective action with a date and a named owner, and tests at the following review whether it was done.

The limits of this evaluation

We have no internal audit function and no independent assurance over this Policy. The review is performed by the two Directors who are also the only people able to breach it. We state that plainly rather than present the review as independent. Appointment of an independent reviewer is a matter for the Board once the Company is large enough to warrant one, and the Stakeholder Advisory Panel committed for Q1 2027 will be invited to comment on this Policy at its first meeting.

11. Raising a concern about our conduct or our lobbying

Anyone may raise a concern about our business conduct or our lobbying practices a worker, an agency worker, a supplier, a client, a member of a trade body we belong to, a public official, or a member of the public. You do not need a relationship with us to do so.

How to raise it

Through our **Stakeholder Grievance Procedure**, which is published in full and freely accessible without a login or account at **praxisbrands.co.uk/grievance**. You may also download it there as a PDF.

Route	Detail
In writing	boyowa@praxisbrands.co.uk, marked for the Grievance Officer
By post	The Grievance Officer, Praxis Brands Ltd, Unit 9 The Workstack, 599 Woolwich Road, Charlton, London SE7 7GS
Anonymously	By any of the above, without giving your name. An anonymous concern is investigated on the same terms as a named one; we simply cannot reply to you directly
If your concern is about the Managing Director or about management	Address it to the Alternate, Robert Price, robert@praxisbrands.co.uk

What happens then

We acknowledge and respond within the deadlines published in the Stakeholder Grievance Procedure v2.2.

Every concern is recorded in our Grievance Register, with what was decided and when, whether it is upheld.

A concern about lobbying or business conduct is reported to the Board, and the Board records what it did about it.

Where the concern is about a trade body speaking in our name rather than about us directly, we still record it and raise it with that body, and we tell you what they said.

An unresolved concern, or any annual summary of concerns, is reported in our annual impact report.

Protection for the person raising it

No one who raises a concern in good faith will suffer any detriment for it — not in their work, their contract, their terms of supply or their relationship with us. This applies whether the concern is upheld or not. Workers making a protected disclosure also have rights under the Public Interest Disclosure Act 1998, which this Policy does not limit.

What we do not claim about this route

The Grievance Officer is the Managing Director, on an interim basis, with the other Director as Alternate for any matter concerning the Managing Director. **We do not describe this**

arrangement as impartial. An independent external grievance channel is a published commitment for Q1 2027, and until it is in place this is what we have and we say so.

12. What we do not yet do

We publish no detailed lobbying disclosure. At our size this is a later-year requirement rather than a first-year one, and we have nothing yet to disclose.

We hold no trade body memberships at present. One lapsed and is being re-established, and the Log will record it when it is.

We have no experience of applying this, Policy. It is written before the fact rather than after it, and the first real test of it will be reported honestly.

We have no independent assurance over the approval step, the Log or the annual review. See section 10.

The Memberships & Positions Log is new and empty. An empty log is the correct state for a company that has held no memberships and taken no positions, but it is not yet evidence that the controls in this Policy work.

13. Accountability

This Policy is approved by the Board of Praxis Brands Ltd, which reviews it and the Memberships & Positions Log at least once a year, records any case where the Policy was not followed and what was done about it, and answers for that to anyone affected.

Accountability is not delegated. Where an action under this Policy is carried out by someone else — an adviser, an agency, a trade body acting in our name — the Board remains accountable for it.

Progress and any positions taken are reported in our annual impact report.

14. Status of this Policy

This Policy supports the Government Affairs & Collective Action impact topic under B Lab's V2 standards, and is read alongside our Stakeholder Grievance Procedure, which carries the concern route referred to in section 11.

It is **available on request** to anyone affected by our conduct. The Board's intention is to publish it at **praxisbrands.co.uk/lobbying**, linked from our Commitments index. Until that page exists we do not describe this Policy as published, and the publication date is recorded as a dated commitment rather than stated as done.

Approved by the Board of Praxis Brands Ltd:

Boyowa Olugbo, Director	Robert Price, Director
Signed: Boyowa Olugb	Signed: Rp
Date: 28/10/2026	Date: 28/10/2026